

Setting up for the course

Reproducible Statistical Reporting with Quarto – fifteen minutes, the week before Day 1

Do this on the machine you will bring, or in the CML workspace you will use on the day. Four steps. When all four pass, you are ready. If one fails, the table at the end says what it means; if that is not enough, contact [name and contact of the course helper] before Day 1.

What you need

- **The course folder**, copied from [where the course folder is shared].
- **Positron**, with R.
- **Quarto 1.9 or later**. Step 2 tells you whether you have it.

Nothing needs downloading from the internet. On an air-gapped machine, never run `quarto install` or `quarto add` – everything the course uses is already inside the course folder.

1. Open the course folder

In Positron, **File** → **Open Folder**, and choose the course folder itself – the one that contains `_brand.yml`, `R/` and `_fonts/`. Not a file inside it: the lab files find the course's helpers by looking for `_brand.yml` at the top of the folder.

2. Check Quarto – in the Terminal

Open a terminal in Positron with **Terminal** → **New Terminal**. It starts in the course folder. Type:

```
quarto check
```

Every line should end in OK. These two matter most:

```
Checking R installation.....OK
Checking Knitr engine render.....OK
```

The lines about Python, Julia, LaTeX and Chrome do not matter. This course uses none of them.

3. Check the R packages – in the R console

In Positron's R console:

```
need <- c("dplyr", "ggplot2", "tidyr", "readr", "stringr", "purrr", "scales",
         "patchwork", "rprojroot", "knitr", "rmarkdown", "tinytable", "quarto")
setdiff(need, rownames(installed.packages()))
```

`character(0)` means nothing is missing. If it prints package names, install those from GASTAT's internal mirror:

```
options(repos = c(CRAN = "[internal mirror URL]"))
install.packages(setdiff(need, rownames(installed.packages())))
```

4. Render the Day 1 lab file – in the Terminal

```
quarto render labs/lab1-start.qmd
```

It takes a few seconds. Near the end you should see:

```
[typst]: Compiling lab1-start.typ to lab1-start.pdf...DONE
Output created: lab1-start.html
```

Two new files appear beside it in `labs/`: `lab1-start.html` and `lab1-start.pdf`. Quarto names only the HTML in its last line, so check that the PDF is there too, and open both. Each is a Labour Market Bulletin for Jazan.

This is the file you build on in the Day 1 lab. If it renders now, it will render at 13:15.

If a step fails

You see	It means	Do this
<code>quarto: command not found</code> , or not recognized	Quarto is missing, or not on your path	[how GASTAT installs Quarto, or who to ask]
Checking R installation does not say OK	Quarto cannot find R	Check that R starts in Positron's console, then contact [the course helper]
Package names printed in step 3	Those packages are missing	Install them as in step 3. If the mirror does not have one – <code>tinytable</code> especially – contact [the course helper]
there is no package called ... in step 4	The same, found later	Step 3
No root directory found in step 4	Positron has a file open, not the course folder –	Step 1

You see	It means	Do this
	or the folder was copied without <code>_brand.yml</code>	
The PDF comes out in a different typeface, or a warning mentions a font	The <code>_fonts/</code> folder did not come with the course folder	Copy the course folder again, complete

On the day

- The machine you set up, charged – or your CML login.
- One real report you have written. We come back to it.
- Optional: fifteen minutes with the markdown cheat sheet sent with this guide.